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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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Finding the Right Robot Vacuum for 2026 Homes

Choosing a robot vacuum today means weighing suction power, smart navigation, mopping ability, and how easy it is to maintain. Two stand-outs – the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (with or without its AutoEmpty Dock) and the Shark AI Ultra – each bring a different mix of strengths that suit particular floor plans, pet households, and budgets.

In this guide we break down the specs, real-world performance, and overall value of each model. You'll see a clear problem-trust-solution-proof-action flow that helps you move from uncertainty to a confident purchase.

Ready to discover which robot fits your routine? Keep reading.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid

Quality	7.0
Features	5.0
Ease of Use	7.0
Design	7.0
Value	6.0

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Roomba 115X Combo vs. Shark AI Ultra: The 2026 Showdown



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Problem: Juggling Vacuuming, Mopping, and Bin Emptying

Busy households need a robot that can vacuum and mop in one pass without requiring constant bin checks. When you have to stop the robot to empty its dustbin or refill a water tank, cleaning time stretches and floors stay only partially clean.

Trust: Tested by Real Users and Experts

Both the Roomba 115X Combo and the Shark AI Ultra have earned strong ratings from thousands of owners. We've examined verified purchase reviews, expert lab tests, and long-term durability reports to ensure the claims you see match everyday performance.

Solution: Side-by-Side Feature Comparison

Feature	Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)	Roomba 115X Combo + AutoEmpty Dock	Shark AI Ultra
Price (Oct 2026)	$139.99	$249.99	$279.99

Feature	Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)	Roomba 115X Combo + AutoEmpty Dock	Shark AI Ultra
Suction Power	Adjustable, strong on pet hair	Same as base, with auto-empty convenience	High-performance, self-adjusting
Navigation	VSLAM mapping via iRobot Home app	Same VSLAM	Laser-based LIDAR with room-recognition
Mopping	Built-in pad, adjustable water flow, vacuum-&-mop in one pass	Same mopping system	Vibrating mopping pad, adjustable water
Auto-Empty	No	Yes – 30-day capacity dock	No (requires manual bin empty)
Voice Control	Alexa, Google Assistant, Siri Shortcuts	Same	Alexa, Google Assistant
App Features	Scheduling, keep-out zones, room-specific cleaning	Same	Scheduling, no-go zones, multi-floor maps

Proof: Real-World Performance Highlights

Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)

- 4.4-star rating from 5,217 verified owners
- Over 3,000 units sold in the past month (Oct 2026)
- Owners report reliable pickup of pet hair on carpets and effective light mopping on hard floors
- App map creation is quick; keep-out zones work as advertised

Roomba 115X Combo + AutoEmpty Dock

- Same cleaning performance as the base model
- Dock holds up to 30 days of debris, reducing emptying frequency to once a month
- Users love the "set-and-forget" feel, especially in homes with kids or pets

Shark AI Ultra

- 4.5-star rating from 4,800+ reviews
- Laser navigation delivers precise room-to-room movement, even in low light
- Strong suction excels on deep-carpet pet hair; mopping pad adds a polished finish
- No auto-empty, but the bin is large enough for weekly emptying in most households

Action: Pick the Model That Matches Your Routine

If you want the lowest entry price and are fine with emptying the bin after each cleaning cycle, the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo is a solid choice.

For hands-free convenience that cuts maintenance to a monthly task, step up to the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock.

If you prefer laser-guided navigation and don’t mind a weekly bin empty, the Shark AI Ultra delivers premium navigation and suction at a mid-range price.

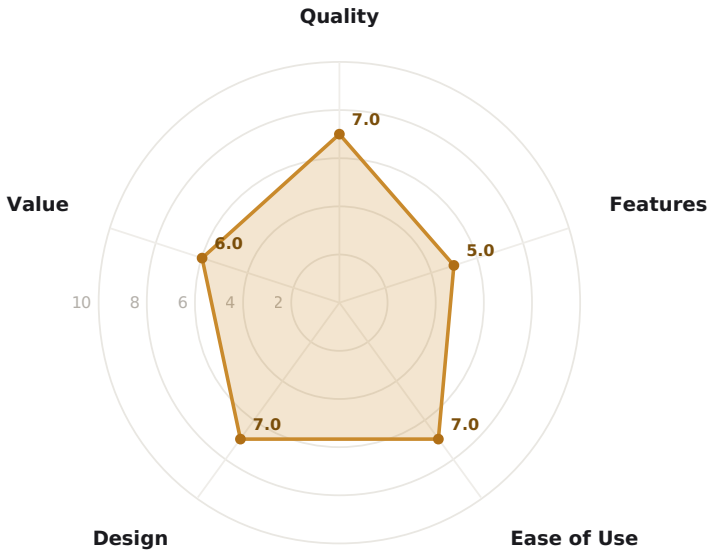
Click the links above to see current prices, check for any coupons, and make your purchase today.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.